The Hobbit

An illustrated edition: plan, art bible & production notes



Working document · build of the dummy interior, cover and style studies

Overview

A complete plan and working production pipeline for a **new illustrated edition of** *The Hobbit, or There and Back Again*, intended for sale only where the text is in the public domain (New Zealand first). The art direction is cosy and intricate: pen-and-watercolour hedgerow detail, **cutaway views** of burrows, halls, cellars and mechanisms, and **a picture on every page turn**.

> ⚖️ *Read* **`docs/01-rights-and-territories.md`** *before anything else. The book is still in copyright in the US, UK, EU, Australia, Canada and most other places. Trademarks and film designs are separate issues, and where copies are printed matters.*

What's here

`output/interior-print.pdf`	**Print-ready interior dummy**: 7 × 10 in + 0.125 in bleed, about 407 pages, front and back matter, contents, plates list, every illustration slot laid out
`output/interior-screen.pdf`	The same at trim size with cream pages, for proofing and digital sale
`output/cover-paperback.pdf`	Wraparound cover (back, spine, front) with the spine sized from the page count; `cover-guides.pdf` shows the guides
`output/cover-ebook-front.jpg`	Ebook store cover
`output/production-notes.pdf`	**All the planning in one PDF**: rights, art bible, illustration plan, production, text preparation, gallery, sample pages
`docs/`	The same planning documents as Markdown
`plan/illustrations.csv`	**The illustration plan**: 176 pieces, each with ID, chapter, type, position, brief, priority and status. Edit it in any spreadsheet.
`art/png/`	Style-study art at 300 ppi: 2 full-page cutaways, a close-up half-page vignette, 19 chapter openers and emblems, 17 natural-history margin studies, 26 drop caps, ornaments, cover art
`art/src/`	The art itself, as code: `wc.py` is a raster pen-and-watercolour engine; `detail.py`, `objects.py`, `small.py` and the `scene_*.py` files draw with it
`book/build.py`	The layout engine (WeasyPrint): places plates and spreads on exact page boundaries, half-pages at page tops, insets with text wrap, critters on any art-less page
`book/cover.py`	Cover builder
`book/book.json`	Title-page and copyright-page details (imprint, ISBNs, territories, dedication)

Two things deliberately left for you

1. **The text of the novel is not included.** You supply it from a legitimate public-domain source in your territory (`docs/05-text-preparation.md`). Until then the dummy uses placeholder Latin, sized to each chapter's length.
2. **The characters are not drawn.** The hobbit, the wizard, the dwarves, the dragon and the rest should be your own designs, and that is also where the risk of resembling the films concentrates. The art bible (§2.6) gives book-based design notes. The style studies cover settings, cutaways, objects and decorations.

Quick start

Install the Python dependencies:

```
pip install weasyprint pymupdf pillow markdown numpy scipy
```

Build the interior (about 2 minutes):

```
python3 book/build.py
```

Build the cover (run after the interior, which sets the page count):

```
python3 book/cover.py
```

Regenerate the illustration-plan document from the CSV:

```
python3 tools/plan_report.py
```

Compile the production-notes PDF:

```
python3 tools/notes_pdf.py
```

Repaint the style-study art (about 2 minutes at 300 dpi):

```
python3 art/src/build_art.py
```

Quick low-resolution previews:

```
WC_DPI=100 python3 art/src/build_art.py
```

AI finishing pass (optional): `tools/ai_refine.py` repaints a style-study render with a Gemini image model while keeping its composition. It needs a Gemini API key; see the art bible, end of §2.11.

Adding finished art: save it as `art/final/<ID>.png` or `.jpg` (e.g. `art/final/P-05-01.jpg`) at the size given in the art bible §2.8 and rebuild. It replaces the labelled placeholder automatically.

Adding the text: save `book/text/01.md` to `book/text/19.md` and rebuild. Every illustration re-flows to its scene.

Next steps

1. Get an NZ IP lawyer's sign-off and do a trademark search (rights doc §1.4–1.5).
2. Transcribe and proofread the text, then rebuild to get the real page count and cost.
3. Design the characters and lock the colour script.
4. Produce the A-priority art: 35 plates and cutaway spreads.
5. Proof copy from an NZ printer, then launch.

1 · Rights, territories and what you may sell where

> *Not legal advice. This is a planning summary compiled in November 2026 to help you ask the right questions. Copyright terms change, and the Tolkien Estate, HarperCollins and Middle-earth Enterprises enforce their rights actively. Before you print a single copy, have an intellectual-property lawyer in each country you plan to sell in confirm the points marked ⚖️.*

1.1 The short version

Question	Answer (as of Nov 2026)
When did Tolkien die?	2 September 1973
Where is *The Hobbit* public domain?	Countries with a **life + 50 years** term that had not extended it before 1 January 2024. **New Zealand** is the clearest English-language example; Tolkien's works entered the public domain there on 1 Jan 2024. ⚖️
Where is it **not** public domain?	The **US** (the 1937 text until 1 Jan 2033; the revised 1951 and 1966 texts much later), the **UK, EU, Australia, Canada, Japan, South Korea, Singapore, Russia** and every other life + 70 country, until **1 Jan 2044**. India and other life + 60 countries: until **1 Jan 2034**.
Is copyright the only issue?	No. **Trademarks** (Middle-earth Enterprises owns marks such as THE HOBBIT and character names in many countries) and the **look of the films** are separate rights that do not expire with the book's copyright.
Can I use the Brambly Hedge style?	A general *style* (pen and watercolour, cutaways, cosy hedgerow detail) is not protected. Specific characters, compositions, the *Brambly Hedge* name and its branding are. Make it your own, and never use the name or Jill Barklem's in your title, marketing, keywords or AI prompts.

1.2 Life + 50 countries to investigate

These countries are commonly listed with a life + 50 term. Each one needs checking for later amendments, rules about foreign works, and whether you can realistically print and distribute there. ⚖️

- **New Zealand**: best first market. English-speaking, life + 50, Tolkien public domain since 2024. NZ committed to life + 70 under its free-trade agreements with the UK and EU, and legislation is reportedly planned for around 2028. Reports say the extension will **not revive** works already in the public domain, but **confirm this before you invest**.
- **South Africa**: English-speaking and life + 50 for literary works. A long-running Copyright Amendment Bill has been in progress, so check its status.
- Others often cited: Egypt, mainland China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, Malaysia, Thailand, the Philippines, Pakistan, Iran, Kenya, Uganda, Zambia, Zimbabwe and Botswana. Some are realistic only for translated editions.

Not on the list: Canada extended to life + 70 on 30 Dec 2022, before Tolkien's term ran out, so it is protected there until 2044.

1.3 Which text to use

Edition	Notes	Risk
1937 first edition (George Allen & Unwin)	The true "original". Chapter 5 tells the riddle-game ending differently.	Lowest
1951 second edition	Tolkien revised Chapter 5 to fit *The Lord of the Rings*.	Low in NZ (same author and term)
1966 third edition	Tolkien's last revision and the familiar modern text.	Low in NZ
Post-1973 printings	May contain editorial corrections, new forewords, notes, or maps redrawn by others.	**Avoid**: later editorial material can carry its own copyright

Rules of thumb:

- **Transcribe from a printing made before 1974**, ideally a 1937–1966 copy you own or can borrow, or a properly sourced public-domain transcription in your territory.
- **Do not scan or OCR a modern edition.** NZ protects the *typographical arrangement* of a published edition for 25 years, so the page layout of a recent HarperCollins printing is off-limits even where the words are free. ⚖️
- Leave out modern introductions, notes, annotated-edition material and any "Note on the Text" written after 1973.
- Tolkien's own drawings and maps for *The Hobbit* are his works too, so the same term applies. The aim of this edition, though, is **all-new art**, so draw new maps rather than tracing his.

1.4 Trademarks and look-alike risk ⚖️

- **Middle-earth Enterprises** (owned by Embracer Group since 2022) holds registrations for names including THE HOBBIT and BILBO BAGGINS in many classes and countries, including printed matter. Search the registers before launch: **IPONZ** (New Zealand) and **CIPC** (South Africa).
- Using a book's real title to describe that book is usually a descriptive, non-trademark use. You strengthen that position by:
- using the full traditional title: *The Hobbit, or There and Back Again*;
- setting the title in your own lettering, never the films' logo or typeface;
- leaving out "Official", "Authorised" and the Tolkien Estate's **JRRT monogram**, which is itself a registered mark;
- carrying a clear disclaimer (wording is in the copyright-page template).
- **Avoid film resemblance.** The 2012–2014 films and the 1977 animated film are separate copyrighted works. Do not echo their character faces, costumes, set designs (the film Bag End, Erebor, Lake-town), creature designs (the film's Smaug walks on his wings), invented characters, or posters.
- **Other illustrators.** Do not copy compositions from any published *Hobbit* illustrator: Tolkien himself, Alan Lee, John Howe, Jemima Catlin, Michael Hague, Tove Jansson, the Rankin/Bass designers, and others.

1.5 Selling: the practical traps

1. **Where the copy is made matters.** Printing a copy is an act of reproduction in the country of printing. A print-on-demand order from a New Zealand customer may be **printed in Australia**, where the book is in copyright until 2044. Use an **NZ-based printer** (or another public-domain territory), and ship only within public-domain territories. ⚖️
2. **Set territories on every platform.** Restrict each digital store to your cleared countries. Expect platforms to ask for proof of public-domain status, and some may refuse the title anyway.
3. **Amazon KDP** has specific public-domain rules: - Your edition must be *differentiated*. "Illustrated" requires **10 or more original illustrations** relevant to the book, and this plan has about 200. - The title field must carry the tag, e.g. *The Hobbit (Illustrated)*. - Public-domain titles are restricted from KDP Select and some royalty options. - You must declare AI-generated content if you use any.
4. **Your own web shop** should geo-restrict both downloads and shipping addresses.
5. **Mark the book.** Put "For sale only in New Zealand [and other cleared territories]" on the copyright page and the back cover.
6. **Expand later.** The book enters the public domain in India and other life + 60 countries in **2034**, in the **US in 2033** (1937 text only), and in the **UK, EU and Australia in 2044**. Make sure your illustration contracts already cover those territories (see the art bible §2.9).

1.6 New Zealand housekeeping

- **ISBNs** are issued **free** by the National Library of New Zealand's ISBN Agency. Use one per format: hardback, paperback, EPUB and PDF.
- **Legal deposit:** NZ publishers must deposit copies of new publications, print and electronic, with the National Library.
- If you trade as a business, register for GST once you pass the turnover threshold.

1.7 Who owns your edition

- **Your illustrations, design, typography, introduction and notes** are new copyright works, and they are what you own and sell.
- **AI-generated art:** in the US, purely AI-generated images cannot be registered for copyright. NZ's Act has a "computer-generated works" provision that may protect them, but this is untested here. Art you create yourself, or substantially rework by hand, is much easier to protect and to defend as "original illustrations". Keep your layered working files as evidence.

Sources

- Newshub (2024): legal copyright expires for Tolkien books, but only in New Zealand
- Copyright Licensing NZ: duration of copyright
- Tompkins Wake: what the NZ–UK FTA means for IP
- Duncan Cotterill: Copyright Act changes coming for New Zealand
- Asia IP: NZ–UK agreement extends copyright term by 20 years
- KDP Help: public domain content
- Middle-earth Enterprises FAQ
- Techdirt: Middle-earth Enterprises opposing use of "Hobbit"

2 · Art bible

This is the single reference for anyone making art for the edition: you, a commissioned illustrator, or a carefully supervised AI-assisted workflow. The style-study pieces in `art/png/` were built to these rules.

2.1 The idea

A cosy, intricate, pen-and-watercolour Hobbit that rewards slow looking. Every page turn offers something to find: a pantry shelf to inspect, a mechanism to trace with a finger, a snail hiding in the corner. Think of an English hedgerow almanac crossed with an engineer's cutaway drawing: warm, domestic and curious, never grim.

Three pillars:

1. **Cutaways and cross-sections.** Show what is inside walls, hills, trees, mountains and machines: larders, cellars, stairs, chimneys, pulleys, roots and burrows.
2. **Abundant small detail.** Real plants, crockery, tools and food, drawn accurately and lovingly, with gentle humour in the details.
3. **Kid-safe wonder.** Danger is felt, not shown. Scary creatures stay in shadow or turn slightly comic, and nothing is bloody.

2.2 Style descriptors

Use this language in every brief and every AI prompt. **Never use an artist's name, a series title such as Brambly Hedge, or a film reference.**

> *fine sepia pen line, soft transparent watercolour washes on warm cream paper, slight granulation, colours occasionally escaping the lines, gentle natural daylight or golden lamplight, botanically accurate English hedgerow plants (bramble, dog-rose, honeysuckle, hawthorn, oak, beech, ferns, mushrooms), rounded cosy architecture, intricate cross-section cutaway, small labelled rooms, abundant tiny domestic details, storybook warmth, children's classic illustration*

Avoid: digital gloss, hard cel shading, heavy black outlines, photorealism, film-like lighting, neon colour, gore, horror faces.

2.3 Palette

Swatches come from `art/src/kit.py`, so all generated art matches.

Role	Hex	Use
Sepia ink	`#3d2b1f`	all line work
Cream paper	`#f6eedb`	page tint inside plates
Earth / clay	`#c09668` `#d2a878` `#80593a`	cut soil, roots, tunnels
Grass / leaf	`#93b062` `#6e9446` `#7f9c4d` `#58773a`	hills, foliage
Bramble berry	`#6e3456`	ornaments, berries, chapter numerals
Dog-rose / pink	`#dc8e7c` `#e9b3a5`	flowers, curtains
Hearth	`#f2a63c` `#e46b2d` `#fbd96e`	fires, lamps, glow
Sky / water	`#b9d2dc` `#86adbf` `#5d8597`	skies, rivers, lakes
Stone	`#c2b7a4` `#a99d8a`	walls, mountains
Gold / brass	`#dcae3e` `#cfa23c`	doorknobs, treasure, keys
Door green	`#4e7d47`	the round door, home

Journey colour-script. The palette shifts chapter by chapter so the reader *feels* the distance from home:

Chapters	Mood	Dominant hues
I–III	Home, green country, an elven valley	fresh greens, cream, dog-rose pink, hearth gold
IV–VI	Mountains, tunnels, fire in the pines	stone greys, cool blues, ember orange at night
VII–IX	Bee-pastures, deep forest, elf-halls	honey gold, then deep moss green and violet, then torch-lit amber
X–XIV	Lake-town, the Mountain, the dragon	lake blue-grey, cold sky, treasure gold, dragon-fire red
XV–XVII	Ravens, gathering armies, storm	slate, steel, storm violet, with shafts of light
XVIII–XIX	Spring return, home again	the greens of Chapter I, only warmer

2.4 Line, wash and texture

- **Ink:** 0.2–0.5 pt at print size, slightly wobbly and broken in places. Use thicker strokes only on silhouette edges.
- **Washes:** transparent and layered (two or three passes), with edges that darken slightly as they dry. Let a wash drift 0.5–1 mm off the line now and then.
- **Shadows:** a cool violet-grey (`#5d4c66`) at about 25% opacity. Never use black.
- **Light:** interiors glow from lamps and hearths, with a soft radial bloom. Exteriors use morning or evening light with long, soft shadows.
- **Paper:** a faint cream grain under everything.

2.5 Cutaway conventions

1. **The cut face** is warm earth (or stone, or wood) and is busy with pebbles, roots, root-hairs, strata lines, a worm, a beetle, a buried treasure.
2. **Rooms are arched cavities.** Draw a darker rim where earth meets plaster, wooden wainscot, tiled floors and a lamp in each room.
3. **Show connections** between rooms: stairs, passages, chimney flues and pipes, so a child can trace a route with a finger.
4. **Label** rooms in small italic hand-lettering ("the Pantry"). Labels sit in clear wall space and never cover detail.
5. **Look-for details:** every cutaway hides at least three, and one of them is always **the snail** (§2.7).
6. **Mechanisms** must be plausible. Gears mesh, ropes run over pulleys, levers have pivots and counterweights. Children notice.

2.6 Characters

You (or your illustrator) design all characters from the text. No character art is included in this repository: these designs are the heart of the edition and should be uniquely yours.

Character	Book-based design notes	Steer away from
The hobbit	Small (about half human height), round-bellied, curly brown hair, bare hairy feet, bright waistcoat colours (the book favours green and yellow), good-humoured, fussy, brave when needed	film actor likeness, film costume colours and cut
The wizard	Very tall, old, long white beard, bushy eyebrows, tall pointed **blue** hat, grey cloak, silver scarf, big boots, a staff	film or actor likeness
Thirteen dwarves	Each instantly recognisable: hood colour, beard shape, instrument, size. Checking the hood colours against your source text is the quickest way to stay faithful	film hairstyles, armour, prosthetic faces
The dragon	Red-gold, four legs **and** a separate pair of wings, a jewel-crusted belly with one bare patch, majestic and vain, more awe than terror	the film design (wings as forelimbs)
The cave-creature	Small, thin, pale lamp-like eyes, paddling a little boat; keep him half-hidden in shadow	film CGI likeness

Character	Book-based design notes	Steer away from
Goblins, wolves, spiders	Comic-grotesque rather than horrifying; big expressive eyes on the spiders; no gore	horror-film designs

Produce a **character sheet** for each before any scene art: front, side and back views, a height chart, a colour swatch and three expressions. Lock these before production.

2.7 The hidden snail

A small brown snail appears **somewhere on every full-page plate and every cutaway spread**. Sometimes it is obvious, sometimes cunning: on a barrel, in a teacup, on a dragon's treasure-pile. A back-matter page, "Did you find the snail?", lists the answers with page numbers. This gives young readers a reason to study every big picture.

2.8 Illustration types and sizes

Master art is **RGB at 300 ppi at final size**. The two "with bleed" sizes are for the print PDF. The layout engine handles bleed, so supply art at the size given.

Code	Type	Final size (in)	Pixels @300	Placement
S	Cutaway spread	14.25 × 10.25	4275 × 3075	Across two facing pages. Keep faces and labels out of the central 0.75 in (gutter).
P	Full-page plate	7.125 × 10.25	2138 × 3075	Full bleed. Keep important content 0.5 in inside every edge, and 0.75 in from the spine side.
H	Half-page	5.5 × 4.0	1650 × 1200	Top or bottom of a text page; may have a soft vignetted edge.
I	Inset spot	2.6 × 2.6	780 × 780	Text wraps around it. Transparent background, irregular edge.
O	Chapter opener	5.5 × 2.0 banner, 1.5 in emblem	—	Bramble banner plus emblem roundel (done as style study).
V	Vignette / tailpiece	2.4 × 0.7	—	End of each chapter.
M	Margin critter	0.9 × 0.7	270 × 210	Automatic, outer bottom corner of any page with no other art.
D	Drop cap	1.0 × 1.0	300 × 300	First letter of each chapter (A–Z done).

File naming: `art/final/<ID>.png`, e.g. `art/final/P-05-01.png`. The build picks these up automatically and replaces the labelled placeholder in the dummy.

2.9 Working with an illustrator

- **Contract:** worldwide, all-media, perpetual rights, either a copyright **assignment** or an exclusive licence. You will want to sell in more countries as the book enters the public domain (2033, 2034, 2044). Include a moral-rights consent for cropping and colour adjustment.
- **Brief each piece** with: its ID, the scene summary from `plan/illustrations.csv`, the size code, the colour-script row, the look-for details, and the character sheets.
- **Approval stages:** thumbnail, then pencil, then ink, then colour. Most changes should happen at the pencil stage.
- **Budget:** about 200 pieces is a large commission. To make it affordable, re-use the M, V, D and O libraries (largely done) and phase the H and I spots.

2.10 If you use AI image tools

1. **Prompt with the style descriptors in §2.2 plus the scene brief.** Never use artist names, series titles or film titles.

2. **Treat AI output as underpainting.** Repaint faces, hands and characters by hand from your character sheets for consistency, and keep layered files as evidence of human authorship.
3. **Check every image** for accidental resemblance to the films or to published illustrations. Reject anything that looks familiar.
4. **Disclose AI content** where platforms require it (KDP does).

Example prompt (scene P-09-01):

> *Children's classic book illustration, full page, portrait. Thirteen small travellers bobbing down a fast forest river inside wooden barrels, only their hooded heads poking out, one small figure clinging on top of a barrel. Beech and oak forest banks, morning light through mist, water splashes. Fine sepia pen line, soft transparent watercolour washes on warm cream paper, slight granulation, botanically accurate plants, gentle humour, storybook warmth. A tiny brown snail riding on one barrel lid.*

2.11 How the style-study art is made, and its limits

The pieces in `art/png/` are painted by code: `art/src/wc.py` is a small raster watercolour engine. It imitates the physical behaviour of the medium:

- **Transparent glazes:** each wash multiplies the paint beneath it, so colours mix and deepen like real pigment layers.
- **Wet edges:** the wash edge wanders slightly, and pigment pools along it as it dries.
- **Granulation:** pigment settles into the hollows of a cold-press paper surface.
- **Mottling:** washes are uneven in density.
- **Modelling:** every form is darker away from a light at the upper left, with fine pen hatching on the shadow side.
- **Pen work:** lines are fine and tapered, sometimes broken, with a faint pencil under-drawing.
- **Reserved whites:** highlights are bare paper.
- **Vignettes:** spot illustrations fade softly into the page.

`art/src/detail.py` holds the high-detail motifs:

- tree crowns built leaf by leaf
- grass blades and wildflowers
- wood grain, flagstones and gingham
- patterned crockery, preserves, herb bunches, netted hams
- an inglenook fire

What it is good for: it fixes the look of the edition: palette, line weight, density, cutaway conventions, page decoration. It also gives an illustrator, or an image tool, an exact layout to work over.

What it is not: no procedural code reaches the draughtsmanship of a master hand-painted picture book. That means observed form, characterful faces and hands, the hundred small decisions in every object. For a commercial edition at that level:

1. Commission an illustrator with this bible and these style studies as the brief, **or**
2. If you use an image model on a GPU service, use these renders as **image-to-image starting points** (composition locked, model adds finish at a low denoising strength), then paint over by hand. Follow §2.10, and keep your layered files.

Art painted by this code (or by any AI tool) counts as **AI-generated** for platform disclosure. It may not be protected by copyright in some countries (see rights doc §1.7). The "original illustrations" that differentiate the edition are safest when a human makes or substantially reworks them.

AI finishing pass (optional): `tools/ai_refine.py`

From this cloud workspace the **Google Gemini API** is reachable, and its image models can repaint a supplied picture. `tools/ai_refine.py`:

- sends a style-study render as the composition guide, plus optional character sheets as `--ref`;
- builds the prompt from §2.2 and the scene brief, with no artist or series names;
- fits the result to the exact print size at 300 dpi;
- logs every generation in `art/ai/log.csv` for disclosure.

Review the variants, paint over by hand, and `--promote` the chosen one into `art/final/`. You need your own Gemini API key, stored as an environment secret and never in the repository. Check Google's current pricing and terms.

3 · Illustration plan

The editable source of truth is `plan/illustrations.csv`: open it in any spreadsheet. The build reads it directly, and this page is regenerated from it by `python3 tools/plan_report.py`.

3.1 How every page turn gets a picture

Layer	Count	What it does
Cutaway spreads (S)	9	The showpieces: double-page cross-sections of the key places
Full-page plates (P)	31	One to three per chapter, at the big story moments
Half-page pictures (H)	40	The top of a text page, roughly every 6–8 pages
Inset spots (I)	55	Small pictures with text wrapping around them
Chapter openers (O)	19	A bramble banner with an emblem roundel, plus an illuminated drop cap (**all drafted**)
Tailpieces (V)	20	A bramble sprig closing each chapter (**drafted**)
Margin critters (M)	13 drafted, aim for about 40	Stamped automatically on any page that has no other art
Blank-page vignettes	automatic	Blank versos before chapter openings show the next chapter's emblem

In the current dummy (407 pages), every page that has no planned art gets a margin critter (206 pages) and every blank page gets a vignette (11). So **no page is ever without a picture**. To make the critter pages richer, add more insets to the CSV; the layout absorbs them automatically.

Totals: 176 planned pieces (priority A: 77, B: 51, C: 48). 41 are already drafted as style studies in `art/png/`.

Priorities:

- **A** is essential for launch.
- **B** strongly wanted.
- **C** can be phased into a later printing; until then a margin critter takes its place.

3.2 The big cutaways

These are the pages people will buy the book for. Each one gets a full research pass: how the room would really be built, lit, heated and stocked.

- **S-01-01: Cutaway: the hobbit-hole.** Double-page cross-section of the hobbit-hole: long tunnel-hall with pegs, many round-windowed rooms on one level, bedrooms, bathrooms, cellars, pantries (lots), wardrobes, kitchens, dining-rooms; the Hill above with a tree and chimney pots.
- **S-03-01: Cutaway: the Last Homely House.** Cross-section of the elf-lord's house: hall of fire, kitchens and pantries, a library of maps, bedrooms, stables, terraces over the river.
- **S-04-01: Cutaway: under the mountains.** Cross-section of the goblin tunnels: the great cavern with its fire, forges and clanking machines, chains, winding passages, hidden back door.
- **S-05-01: Cutaway: down to the lake.** Cross-section of tunnels sloping down to the lake cavern and its island; dripping stone; the hobbit's path.
- **S-07-01: Cutaway: the great wooden hall.** Cross-section of the farmstead: long timber hall with central hearth and carved pillars, sleeping platform, barns, dairy, honey stores, stalls, hives in the garden.
- **S-09-01: Cutaway: halls and cellars.** Cross-section of the elf-king's caves: halls, dungeon cells, wine cellars, the trapdoor over the underground river, the water-gate. (Single-page style study made: plate_cellar_mechanism.)
- **S-10-01: Cutaway: the stilt town.** Cross-section of the lake town: houses on piles, walkways, market, warehouses, boats moored beneath, the Master's hall.

- **S-12-01: Cutaway: inside the Mountain.** Cross-section of the Mountain: secret door and tunnel, great treasure hall with the sleeping dragon, old dwarf halls, stairs, forges, the river and front gate.
- **S-19-01: Cutaway: the hobbit-hole set to rights.** Cross-section of the hobbit-hole put back in order: treasure chests in the cellar, a study with maps, the sword over the mantel, memoirs on the desk.

3.3 Chapter by chapter

I. An Unexpected Party

About 8,900 words · about 34 pages in the dummy · palette: home greens, cream, hearth gold

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-01	Opener	start	Chapter I opener	Bramble banner; emblem: teapot, cups and seed-cake.	A	style-study
P-01-01	Plate	3%	A fine morning at the round door	The hobbit at his round green door on a bright morning; a tall old wizard in a pointed blue hat leaning on his staff at the garden gate; flowers, path, fence.	A	planned
S-01-01	Cutaway spread	8%	Cutaway: the hobbit-hole	Double-page cross-section of the hobbit-hole: long tunnel-hall with pegs, many round-windowed rooms on one level, bedrooms, bathrooms, cellars, pantries (lots), wardrobes, kitchens, dining-rooms; the Hill above with a tree and chimney pots.	A	planned
I-01-01	Inset	12%	The mark on the door	The wizard scratching a small secret sign on the shiny green paint with the end of his staff.	B	planned
H-01-01	Half-page	20%	Hoods on the pegs	The hall filling up as dwarves arrive one and two at a time; coloured hoods hung on a row of pegs; the hobbit's astonished face.	A	planned
I-01-02	Inset	28%	The doorbell again	The flustered hobbit hurrying down the hall with a tray of cakes as the bell rings yet again.	B	planned
H-01-02	Half-page	38%	The great tea	Dwarves round the table with seed-cake, jam, pies, cheese, cold chicken and pickles; the hobbit carrying more.	A	planned
I-01-03	Inset	45%	The washing-up	Dwarves tossing plates and juggling glasses as they wash up — nothing broken.	B	planned
P-01-02	Plate	55%	Music by the fire	Dark room lit only by firelight; dwarves playing harps, fiddles, flutes, a drum, viols and a clarinet; deep shadows; the hobbit entranced.	A	planned
I-01-04	Inset	65%	Overcome on the hearthrug	The hobbit swooning dramatically on the hearthrug while dwarves peer down (comic).	C	planned
H-01-03	Half-page	75%	The map and the key	The wizard spreading a parchment map by lamplight, pointing at a hidden door; a small key with an odd ward lying on it.	A	planned
I-01-05	Inset	83%	The key on its chain	Close-up: an old silver key on a fine chain.	C	planned
I-01-06	Inset	92%	Dreams in a small bed	The hobbit asleep in a little round-windowed bedroom, dreaming of mountains.	B	planned
V-01	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

II. Roast Mutton

About 5,200 words · about 22 pages in the dummy · palette: wet greens and greys; troll-fire orange

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-02	Opener	start	Chapter II opener	Emblem: campfire with cooking pot on a tripod.	A	style-study
H-02-01	Half-page	5%	Running down the lane	The hobbit dashing out of his door without hat or handkerchief, breakfast things left on the table.	A	planned

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
I-02-01	Inset	15%	On the pony	The hobbit bouncing on a laden pony, the dwarves' coloured hoods ahead.	B	planned
P-02-01	Plate	27%	Rain on the road	Grey rain over lonely hills; ponies trudging; dripping hoods; a ruined tower on a hill.	B	planned
I-02-02	Inset	37%	A light between the trees	A red firelight glimpsed through dark tree trunks.	C	planned
P-02-02	Plate	50%	Three trolls at their fire	Three huge, dim, comic trolls round a fire roasting mutton on spits; the hobbit creeping up behind a tree (warm, funny, not scary).	A	planned
I-02-03	Inset	60%	The talking purse	A troll's purse squeaking out a complaint in the hobbit's hand.	C	planned
H-02-02	Half-page	72%	Dwarves in sacks	Trolls squabbling while dwarves wriggle in sacks on the ground.	B	planned
I-02-04	Inset	82%	Turned to stone	Dawn light on three stone trolls; a bird perched on a stone nose.	A	planned
H-02-03	Half-page	92%	The trolls' cave	Inside the trolls' cave: pots of gold, food, old clothes and a pile of swords; a stone door ajar.	B	planned
V-02	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

III. A Short Rest

About 3,100 words · about 14 pages in the dummy · palette: twilight blue, lantern gold, valley green

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-03	Opener	start	Chapter III opener	Emblem: open book with candle and crescent moon.	A	style-study
P-03-01	Plate	20%	The hidden valley at dusk	Looking down a steep path into a secret valley: a river, a waterfall, lanterns in the trees, the glow of a house.	A	planned
S-03-01	Cutaway spread	45%	Cutaway: the Last Homely House	Cross-section of the elf-lord's house: hall of fire, kitchens and pantries, a library of maps, bedrooms, stables, terraces over the river.	A	planned
I-03-01	Inset	60%	Old swords with runes	Two old swords and a knife laid on a table, runes along the blades.	B	planned
H-03-01	Half-page	75%	Moon-letters	Silver letters shining on the map under a crescent moon at a window.	A	planned
I-03-02	Inset	90%	Midsummer morning	Ponies re-shod and packs re-filled; the company riding out on a bright morning.	C	planned
V-03	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

IV. Over Hill and Under Hill

About 4,000 words · about 18 pages in the dummy · palette: storm grey, stone, goblin-forge red

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-04	Opener	start	Chapter IV opener	Emblem: lantern in a stone arch.	A	style-study
P-04-01	Plate	15%	Thunder-battle	A night storm in the high pass; vast misty stone-giants far across the valley hurling boulders; the company pressed against the cliff.	A	planned
I-04-01	Inset	30%	A dry cave	The company and ponies settling into a sheltering cave.	B	planned
H-04-01	Half-page	40%	The crack opens	A crack yawning in the back of the cave; ponies vanishing; shadowy goblin arms (comic-grotesque).	B	planned

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
S-04-01	Cutaway spread	55%	Cutaway: under the mountains	Cross-section of the goblin tunnels: the great cavern with its fire, forges and clanking machines, chains, winding passages, hidden back door.	A	planned
I-04-02	Inset	70%	Blades that glow	Two old swords glowing blue in the dark.	B	planned
H-04-02	Half-page	85%	Running in the dark	The dwarves fleeing down black tunnels, the hobbit carried on a dwarf's back.	B	planned
V-04	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

V. Riddles in the Dark

About 6,100 words · about 24 pages in the dummy · palette: deep blue-black, pale lamp-light, gold glint

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-05	Opener	start	Chapter V opener	Emblem: a gold ring on a stone by dark water.	A	style-study
I-05-01	Inset	5%	Alone in the dark	The hobbit sitting alone in pitch dark, his small sword glowing faintly.	B	planned
H-05-01	Half-page	15%	The underground lake	A cold black lake, a tiny rocky island, a small boat paddled by a pale-eyed creature (kept in shadow).	A	planned
S-05-01	Cutaway spread	30%	Cutaway: down to the lake	Cross-section of tunnels sloping down to the lake cavern and its island; dripping stone; the hobbit's path.	A	planned
P-05-01	Plate	45%	The riddle game	The hobbit, sword out, facing the creature perched on a rock with lamp-like eyes; black water between them.	A	planned
I-05-02	Inset	52%	Riddle vignette: a mountain	A mountain with roots and a cloud (visual riddle answer).	C	planned
I-05-03	Inset	58%	Riddle vignette: the wind	Leaves and seeds swirling on the wind.	C	planned
I-05-04	Inset	64%	Riddle vignette: an egg	A speckled egg in a nest.	C	planned
I-05-05	Inset	70%	Riddle vignette: a fish	A fish in dark water.	C	planned
I-05-06	Inset	76%	Riddle vignette: time	An hourglass with crumbling stone and a tiny tree.	C	planned
H-05-02	Half-page	86%	Squeezing through the door	The invisible hobbit squeezing through a half-open door past goblin guards, brass buttons popping.	A	planned
I-05-07	Inset	93%	Lost buttons	Brass buttons scattered on a doorstep.	C	planned
V-05	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

VI. Out of the Frying-Pan into the Fire

About 6,100 words · about 24 pages in the dummy · palette: moonlit blue, ember orange, dawn pink

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-06	Opener	start	Chapter VI opener	Emblem: eagle feather and pine-cones.	A	style-study
H-06-01	Half-page	8%	Daylight again	The hobbit blinking in sunshine on the mountainside; the dwarves arguing in a dell below.	B	planned
I-06-01	Inset	20%	Surprise!	The hobbit suddenly appearing among the dwarves (comic surprise).	B	planned
H-06-02	Half-page	35%	Down the scree	The company sliding down a slope of loose stones towards a pine wood.	B	planned
P-06-01	Plate	50%	Up the trees	Moonlit glade; the company clinging in the tops of fir trees; wolves circling below as shadows; a dwarf hanging from a branch.	A	planned

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
I-06-02	Inset	60%	Flaming pine-cones	The wizard hurling flaming pine-cones into the glade.	B	planned
P-06-02	Plate	75%	The eagles	Great eagles lifting the company from the burning trees into the dawn sky.	A	planned
H-06-03	Half-page	88%	The eyrie	A high rock shelf; a fire roasting supper; the wide land far below at sunset.	B	planned
V-06	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

VII. Queer Lodgings

About 9,200 words · about 36 pages in the dummy · palette: honey gold, clover pink, timber brown

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-07	Opener	start	Chapter VII opener	Emblem: honey pot with bees.	A	style-study
P-07-01	Plate	5%	The Carrock	Eagles setting the company down on a great rock in a river at morning.	B	planned
H-07-01	Half-page	15%	Bee-pastures	Walking through fields of clover and flowers with enormous bees and rows of hives.	A	planned
I-07-01	Inset	20%	A giant bee	Close-up of a huge furry bee on a flower, the hobbit for scale.	B	planned
S-07-01	Cutaway spread	30%	Cutaway: the great wooden hall	Cross-section of the farmstead: long timber hall with central hearth and carved pillars, sleeping platform, barns, dairy, honey stores, stalls, hives in the garden.	A	planned
H-07-02	Half-page	40%	Two at a time	Dwarves appearing at the door in pairs while the wizard tells his story.	B	planned
P-07-02	Plate	50%	Supper served by animals	Dogs walking on hind legs and ponies and sheep carrying in tables, torches, honey, cream and bread.	A	planned
I-07-02	Inset	62%	Torches and tables	Animals bringing in torches and trestle tables (comic).	C	planned
I-07-03	Inset	72%	Night noises	The hobbit awake in bed; a great bear shadow on moonlit grass outside.	B	planned
H-07-03	Half-page	82%	A hearty breakfast	Morning: the host laughing at the head of the table; packs filled with food.	B	planned
I-07-04	Inset	88%	Honey-cakes	A basket of twice-baked honey-cakes and earthenware jars.	C	planned
H-07-04	Half-page	95%	The forest gate	The dark arch where the path enters the great forest; ponies being sent home.	A	planned
V-07	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

VIII. Flies and Spiders

About 9,500 words · about 36 pages in the dummy · palette: moss green, violet gloom, butterfly black

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-08	Opener	start	Chapter VIII opener	Emblem: dewy spider-web.	A	style-study
P-08-01	Plate	5%	Inside the forest	A dim green tunnel of trees; black squirrels; glinting eyes in the dark; the path.	A	planned
I-08-01	Inset	12%	The black stream	A dark enchanted stream with a little boat on the far bank.	B	planned
H-08-01	Half-page	18%	Hauling the boat	Pulling the boat across with a rope; one dwarf toppling into the water.	B	planned
I-08-02	Inset	25%	A sleeping dwarf	Carrying a fast-asleep stout dwarf on a stretcher of branches.	C	planned

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
I-08-03	Inset	32%	Climbing for a look	The hobbit climbing a tall tree towards the light.	B	planned
P-08-02	Plate	38%	Above the leaves	The hobbit's head poking out above a sea of leaves; velvety black butterflies in sunshine.	A	planned
H-08-02	Half-page	45%	Feast in a glade	An elvish feast by torchlight in a clearing; dwarves stumbling in as the lights go out.	B	planned
I-08-04	Inset	55%	Naming the sword	The hobbit alone, sword raised, having beaten off a spider (spider comic).	A	planned
P-08-03	Plate	65%	The spider colony	Dwarves wrapped in silk bundles hanging from branches; cartoonish spiders; the hobbit throwing stones from the shadows.	A	planned
I-08-05	Inset	72%	Taunting songs	Spiders fuming as the invisible hobbit sings rude rhymes (comic).	C	planned
H-08-03	Half-page	80%	Cutting them free	The hobbit slashing silk; dazed dwarves tumbling out.	B	planned
I-08-06	Inset	90%	Lost and weary	The company in an exhausted circle; one place empty.	C	planned
V-08	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

IX. Barrels Out of Bond

About 5,500 words · about 24 pages in the dummy · palette: torch amber, cellar stone, river green

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-09	Opener	start	Chapter IX opener	Emblem: a barrel with apples.	A	style-study
H-09-01	Half-page	8%	Into the elf-king's halls	Dwarves marched over a bridge into great cave gates by torchlight.	B	planned
S-09-01	Cutaway spread	25%	Cutaway: halls and cellars	Cross-section of the elf-king's caves: halls, dungeon cells, wine cellars, the trapdoor over the underground river, the water-gate. (Single-page style study made: plate_cellar_mechanism.)	A	style-study
I-09-01	Inset	35%	Sneaking unseen	The invisible hobbit's shadow slipping along a torch-lit corridor.	C	planned
I-09-02	Inset	45%	Asleep over the wine	The butler and the guard asleep at a table over flagons; keys on the belt.	B	planned
H-09-02	Half-page	55%	Packing the barrels	Dwarves being packed into barrels with straw (comic); lids being hammered.	A	planned
P-09-01	Plate	70%	Down the trapdoor	Barrels tumbling through the trapdoor into the river below; the hobbit grabbing the last one.	A	planned
P-09-02	Plate	85%	Riding the river	Barrels bobbing down a misty forest river at dawn; the hobbit astride one.	A	planned
I-09-03	Inset	95%	Ashore	Barrels bumping into the shallows near a lake town.	C	planned
V-09	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

X. A Warm Welcome

About 3,700 words · about 16 pages in the dummy · palette: lake blue-grey, lantern gold

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-10	Opener	start	Chapter X opener	Emblem: rowing boat and reeds.	A	style-study
P-10-01	Plate	10%	The town on the lake	A wooden town on stilts on a long lake; the lonely Mountain far beyond.	A	planned

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
S-10-01	Cutaway spread	30%	Cutaway: the stilt town	Cross-section of the lake town: houses on piles, walkways, market, warehouses, boats moored beneath, the Master's hall.	A	planned
H-10-01	Half-page	50%	A surprising announcement	A dwarf in a feasting hall declaring who he is; astonished townsfolk.	B	planned
I-10-01	Inset	70%	A dreadful cold	The hobbit sneezing by a fire, wrapped in blankets (comic).	C	planned
H-10-02	Half-page	90%	Off up the lake	Boats loaded with supplies setting out; crowds waving from the walkways.	B	planned
V-10	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XI. On the Doorstep

About 2,800 words · about 14 pages in the dummy · palette: bare grey-brown, sunset gold

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-11	Opener	start	Chapter XI opener	Emblem: a key and a snail on a stone.	A	style-study
H-11-01	Half-page	15%	The desolation	A bare, burned valley; ruins of a town; the Mountain looming.	B	planned
P-11-01	Plate	40%	The hidden bay	A grassy ledge and smooth rock wall high on the mountainside; the hobbit gazing west.	A	planned
I-11-01	Inset	60%	The thrush and the snail	A thrush knocking a snail on a grey stone (the snail motif's big moment).	A	planned
P-11-02	Plate	82%	The keyhole	The last ray of sunset lighting a keyhole on the rock wall; the key turning.	A	planned
V-11	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XII. Inside Information

About 6,800 words · about 26 pages in the dummy · palette: treasure gold, dragon red, smoke

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-12	Opener	start	Chapter XII opener	Emblem: goblet and coins.	A	style-study
H-12-01	Half-page	8%	Down the tunnel	The hobbit creeping alone down a long tunnel towards a red glow.	A	planned
S-12-01	Cutaway spread	20%	Cutaway: inside the Mountain	Cross-section of the Mountain: secret door and tunnel, great treasure hall with the sleeping dragon, old dwarf halls, stairs, forges, the river and front gate.	A	planned
P-12-01	Plate	32%	The sleeping dragon	A vast red-gold dragon asleep on a mountain of treasure in a warm glow (majestic, not frightening).	A	planned
I-12-01	Inset	42%	The two-handled cup	The hobbit staggering off with a great two-handled cup.	B	planned
I-12-02	Inset	55%	Smoke and rage	Billowing smoke and a flash of fire from the mountainside (no figures hurt).	C	planned
H-12-02	Half-page	70%	A riddling conversation	The invisible hobbit talking to the dragon, who has one eye open amid the gold.	A	planned
I-12-03	Inset	80%	A bare patch	The dragon's jewel-crusted belly with one bare patch (look-for detail).	B	planned
H-12-03	Half-page	93%	Fire on the doorstep	Dwarves diving into the tunnel as fire blasts the ledge; the door closing.	B	planned
V-12	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XIII. Not at Home

About 4,300 words · about 16 pages in the dummy · palette: torch amber, cold stone

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-13	Opener	start	Chapter XIII opener	Emblem: a candle and its long shadow.	A	style-study
I-13-01	Inset	10%	A flickering torch	The hobbit in pitch dark holding up a flickering torch.	B	planned
H-13-01	Half-page	30%	The great white gem	The empty treasure hall glinting; the hobbit finding a glowing white gem.	A	planned
I-13-02	Inset	42%	Into the pocket	The gem glinting from the hobbit's pocket (look-for).	C	planned
P-13-01	Plate	56%	Choosing armour	Dwarves trying on helmets and mail; a small shining mail-coat for the hobbit (costume-fitting fun).	A	planned
H-13-02	Half-page	75%	The old halls	Climbing great stairs through crumbling, carved dwarf halls by torchlight.	B	planned
I-13-03	Inset	90%	The old look-out	Camping in a ruined guard-post above the river valley.	C	planned
V-13	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XIV. Fire and Water

About 3,700 words · about 16 pages in the dummy · palette: night blue, dragon-fire red, steam white

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-14	Opener	start	Chapter XIV opener	Emblem: a single black-feathered arrow under a crescent moon.	A	style-study
P-14-01	Plate	25%	Dragon over the lake town	Night; the dragon descending on the lake town; lamps, bells, boats (dramatic, no injuries shown).	A	planned
I-14-01	Inset	40%	The thrush's message	A thrush perched on an archer's shoulder, whispering.	A	planned
H-14-01	Half-page	55%	The black arrow	An arrow in flight; the dragon falling towards the lake in a great cloud of steam.	A	planned
I-14-02	Inset	70%	Steam and sparks	Steam and sparks rising over dark water.	C	planned
H-14-02	Half-page	86%	On the shore	Townsfolk sheltering in tents on the shore; elves arriving with food and help.	B	planned
V-14	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XV. The Gathering of the Clouds

About 3,700 words · about 16 pages in the dummy · palette: slate, raven black, campfire

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-15	Opener	start	Chapter XV opener	Emblem: a thrush on a twig.	A	style-study
H-15-01	Half-page	15%	The old raven	An ancient raven on a stone talking with the dwarves.	A	planned
I-15-01	Inset	30%	Birds on the wing	Flocks of birds streaming across the valley.	C	planned
P-15-01	Plate	50%	Building the wall	Dwarves building a stone wall across the great front gate.	B	planned
H-15-02	Half-page	75%	Camp in the valley	Campfires of men and elves in the valley below at dusk.	B	planned
I-15-02	Inset	90%	A parley	Messengers at the foot of the wall with a horn and banner.	C	planned
V-15	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XVI. A Thief in the Night

About 2,100 words · about 10 pages in the dummy · palette: night blue, gem white

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-16	Opener	start	Chapter XVI opener	Emblem: a glowing white gem.	A	style-study
H-16-01	Half-page	20%	Down the rope	The hobbit climbing down the wall on a rope at night.	A	planned
P-16-01	Plate	50%	The gift in the tent	In a lantern-lit tent, the hobbit unwrapping the white gem before an elf-king and a bowman.	A	planned
I-16-01	Inset	85%	An old friend	The wizard rising from a corner of the tent with a twinkle.	B	planned
V-16	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XVII. The Clouds Burst

About 3,700 words · about 16 pages in the dummy · palette: storm violet, steel, shafts of light

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-17	Opener	start	Chapter XVII opener	Emblem: a round wooden shield and spears.	A	style-study
H-17-01	Half-page	15%	An army over the hills	A host of dwarves marching over the eastern hills.	B	planned
P-17-01	Plate	40%	The valley under storm	The battle seen from far above as a panorama under a darkening sky (no gore).	A	planned
I-17-01	Inset	55%	On the lookout hill	The invisible hobbit watching from a rocky hill.	B	planned
P-17-02	Plate	75%	The eagles are coming	Great eagles sweeping in against storm clouds lit by the setting sun.	A	planned
I-17-02	Inset	90%	A knock on the helmet	A small stone bouncing off the hobbit's helmet (soft, comic).	C	planned
V-17	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XVIII. The Return Journey

About 2,800 words · about 12 pages in the dummy · palette: spring greens, snow white, Yule red

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-18	Opener	start	Chapter XVIII opener	Emblem: a traveller's pack and walking stick.	A	style-study
H-18-01	Half-page	15%	Farewell by candlelight	A quiet farewell in a candle-lit tent between old companions (gentle, no injuries shown).	A	planned
I-18-01	Inset	35%	A memorial stone	A stone in the mountain's heart with flowers laid on it.	C	planned
P-18-01	Plate	60%	Homeward in spring	The hobbit on a pony with two small chests, riding through spring woodland with the wizard.	A	planned
I-18-02	Inset	80%	Yule in the great hall	A cosy winter feast in the great wooden hall; snow outside.	B	planned
H-18-02	Half-page	95%	The road home	The green road winding home through spring country.	B	planned
V-18	Tailpiece	end	Tailpiece	Bramble tailpiece.	C	style-study

XIX. The Last Stage

About 4,000 words · about 21 pages in the dummy · palette: warm home greens, hearth gold

ID	Type	Where	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
O-19	Opener	start	Chapter XIX opener	Emblem: the round green door, home again.	A	style-study
P-19-01	Plate	10%	Back in the hidden valley	Night in the elf valley; elves singing in the trees; the travellers arriving.	B	planned
I-19-01	Inset	30%	The buried gold	Digging up a pot of troll-gold under a tree.	C	planned
H-19-01	Half-page	50%	The auction	The hobbit arriving home to find his furniture being auctioned on the lawn (comic).	A	planned
S-19-01	Cutaway spread	65%	Cutaway: the hobbit-hole set to rights	Cross-section of the hobbit-hole put back in order: treasure chests in the cellar, a study with maps, the sword over the mantel, memoirs on the desk.	A	planned
P-19-02	Plate	85%	Tea with old friends	Years later: the wizard and a white-bearded dwarf visiting, tea by the fire.	A	planned
I-19-02	Inset	95%	A jar on the table	Laughter round a jar on the tea-table (closing image).	C	planned
V-19	Tailpiece	end	Finis	Large closing tailpiece with the snail.	B	style-study

Front and back matter

ID	Type	Title	Brief	Pri	Status
FM-M1	Map	Endpaper map: the journey	An original hand-drawn map of the whole journey in the edition's style: the Hill, the elf valley, the Misty Mountains, the Carrock, the great forest, the Long Lake and the Mountain. Compass rose, little vignettes of each stop, the snail at the edge.	A	planned
FM-P1	Plate	Frontispiece: the burrow-home cutaway	Single-page cutaway of a hillside burrow-home: round door, hall, parlour, kitchen, pantry, cellar, chimney, roots. STYLE STUDY made — replace or refine with the final version.	A	style-study
FM-V1	Tailpiece	Title-page vignette	Round green door in a grassy hill, lantern, smoke from the chimney.	B	style-study
BM-P1	Plate	Did you find the snail?	Back-matter page of small thumbnails of each plate with the snail circled.	B	planned
BM-M1	Map	Back endpaper	Mirror of the front map, or a hedgerow pattern sheet.	C	planned

Word counts are planning estimates (±15%), used only to size the placeholder text. Scene briefs are summaries written for this plan; they contain no text from the novel.

4 · Production and publishing

4.1 Formats

Format	Spec	File	Notes
Paperback	7 × 10 in, premium colour interior, white paper, matte cover	`output/interior-print.pdf` + `output/cover-paperback.pdf`	The most affordable print edition.
Hardcover	7 × 10 in, case-laminate (printed boards), optional dust jacket	`output/interior-print.pdf` + the printer's hardcover template	The gift edition. The cover needs the printer's own template: wrap and hinge allowances differ from a paperback.
PDF ebook	7 × 10 in, cream page tint, no bleed	`output/interior-screen.pdf`	Sell direct (your own shop, geo-restricted) or through PDF-friendly stores.
EPUB ebook	Reflowable EPUB 3 with images	(next step)	Best for Kindle, Kobo and Apple Books. Text reflows; plates become full-screen images and insets sit inline. Build this once the text is final.

4.2 Interior specifications (already set in `book/build.py`)

- **Trim:** 7 × 10 in. **Bleed:** 0.125 in on the outside, top and bottom, so the page size with bleed is 7.125 × 10.25 in.
- **Margins from trim:** top 0.75 in; bottom 0.85 in; inside (gutter) 0.875 in; outside 0.625 in.
- The text block is 5.5 × 8.4 in.
- The gutter is above KDP's minimum (0.625 in for 301–500 pages, 0.75 in for 501–700).
- **Type:**
- Body: EB Garamond 13/18.5 pt, justified and hyphenated. A comfortable read-aloud size for ages 7 and up.
- Display: IM Fell English, IM Fell French Canon and IM Fell English SC.
- Both are SIL Open Font Licence, embedded and commercially usable. Licences are in `fonts/`.
- **Images:** 300 ppi at final size, RGB. The printer converts to CMYK.
- Before final upload, ask your printer for their ICC profile and do a soft-proof.
- Keep total ink below about 300%.
- Bright greens and violets can shift, so print a proof copy.
- **PDF:** fonts embedded, no crop marks (KDP and IngramSpark both want none). If your printer asks for PDF/X-1a or PDF/X-4, convert the file in Acrobat Pro or with Ghostscript.
- **Front matter** (roman folios, no running heads):
- half-title
- frontispiece
- title page
- copyright page
- dedication
- contents
- plates and cutaways list
- note on the edition
- map spread
- **Back matter:** "Did you find the snail?", about the illustrator, finis.

4.3 Page count and cost

The dummy built today is **407 pages** with placeholder text at estimated chapter lengths, a spine of about 0.95 in. Expect ±10% once your real text is in.

Four hundred colour pages printed on demand make an **expensive** book. Get a quote from your printer's calculator before setting a price. Options if it is too dear:

1. **Two volumes:** Part One (Chapters I–IX, about 220 pp) and Part Two (X–XIX, about 190 pp). Each is a comfortable bedtime-reading length.
2. **A short offset run with an NZ printer** (500–1,500 copies). The unit cost drops sharply and it solves the "where is it printed" problem (rights doc §1.5).
3. **Reduce pages:** 12/17 pt body text saves about 8%. Reducing plate count saves pages too, but don't cut the cutaways: they are the book's selling point.

4.4 ISBNs and metadata

- Use a separate ISBN for each format (hardback, paperback, EPUB, PDF). NZ ISBNs are free from the National Library of New Zealand. Put them in `book/book.json`; they print on the copyright page.
- **Title field:** *The Hobbit, or There and Back Again (Illustrated)*. Some platforms, KDP included, *require* the "(Illustrated)" tag for a differentiated public-domain edition.
- **Contributors:** J. R. R. Tolkien (author); you (illustrator).
- **Categories:**
- BISAC JUV037000 (Juvenile Fiction / Fantasy & Magic)
- JUV001000 (Action & Adventure)
- FIC009000 (Fiction / Fantasy) for adult collectors
- **Age range:** 7–12 for reading aloud, 9+ for independent reading.
- **Keywords:** illustrated classic, watercolour illustrations, cutaway illustrations, gift edition, read-aloud classic. Avoid "Brambly Hedge", film titles, other illustrators' names and trademarked terms you do not need.
- **Territories:** New Zealand only, plus any other countries your lawyer clears.

4.5 Platform notes

Platform	Territory control	Notes
IngramSpark	Per-market rights and pricing	Reaches NZ booksellers and libraries. Check *where* NZ orders are printed (rights doc §1.5).
Amazon KDP	Per-country rights	Public-domain policy: illustrated differentiation, "(Illustrated)" in the title, may ask for proof. AI-content disclosure is required. Expect manual review.
Kobo Writing Life	Per-country	Strong in NZ through retailer partners.
Apple Books	Per-country	EPUB only.
Your own shop	You control it	Geo-block downloads and shipping. Sell signed hardcovers here.
Local NZ printer	—	Best for the physical edition: printing happens in a public-domain territory.

4.6 Production schedule (a realistic outline)

Phase	What	Rough length
0	IP lawyer review (NZ), trademark search, decide territories	2–4 weeks
1	Transcribe and proofread the text, then build the real page count	3–6 weeks

Phase	What	Rough length
2	Character design sheets and colour script, signed off	4–6 weeks
3	Art production, priority **A** first (35 plates and spreads; the 19 openers are already drafted)	6–12 months
4	Priority **B** and **C** halves and insets (or phase them into a second printing)	runs alongside phase 3
5	Layout pass with final art, proofreading in layout, cover final	3–4 weeks
6	Printed proof copies, colour check, corrections	2–4 weeks
7	Launch: NZ legal deposit, store listings, review copies	—

4.7 Pre-flight checklist

- ☐ Lawyer has confirmed public-domain status and the extension position for every sales territory.
- ☐ Trademark searches done (IPONZ, CIPC). The title treatment is your own lettering, with no film or estate marks.
- ☐ Text comes from a pre-1974 printing, proofread twice, with no modern editorial material.
- ☐ Every illustration is original and checked for resemblance to films and published illustrations. Contracts assign or license worldwide rights.
- ☐ `output/build-report.md` shows no placeholder chapters, and every A-priority item has final art.
- ☐ Copyright page completed: territories, ISBNs, printer, disclaimer.
- ☐ Spine width checked against the printer's calculator, and `book/cover.py --pages N` re-run.
- ☐ Proof copy approved: colour, gutter, plates on the correct sides, nothing important in the gutter of spreads.
- ☐ Platform territories restricted. "For sale only in ..." appears on the copyright page and back cover.
- ☐ Legal deposit copies sent to the National Library of New Zealand.

5 · Preparing the text

The repository has **no text of the novel** in it. The dummy PDFs use placeholder Latin sized to each chapter's approximate length. You supply the real text from a legitimate public-domain source in your territory (see `01-rights-and-territories.md` §1.3), and the build re-flows every illustration around it automatically.

5.1 Source

1. **Choose your edition.** For an "original" edition, use the **1937 first edition** text. If you prefer the familiar wording, use the 1966 third edition. Do not mix them.
2. **Get a pre-1974 printing** you can work from: your own copy, a library copy, or scans you are entitled to use in your territory.
3. **Transcribe or OCR it yourself, then proofread twice** against the printed page, the second time reading aloud. Classic OCR errors to check: - "rn" read as "m" - "tbe" for "the" - lost italics - broken hyphenation at line ends - dropped song lines
4. **Leave out** anything not in the source printing, and anything written by others: forewords, notes, appendices, modern maps.

5.2 File format

Make one file per chapter: `book/text/01.md` to `book/text/19.md`. UTF-8 plain text.

```
# An Unexpected Party

First paragraph of the chapter. The opening letter becomes the
illuminated drop cap automatically, and the first few words are set
in small caps.

Second paragraph. Use *asterisks* for italics. Straight "quotes" and
'apostrophes' are converted to curly ones; -- becomes an en dash and
--- an em dash.

> A line of a song or poem
> each line starting with ">"
> forms one verse block.

***

The paragraph after a section break.

{{art:H-01-03}}

A line like the one above pins an illustration to that exact spot.
Without pins, illustrations are placed from the 'position' column in
plan/illustrations.csv (0 = chapter start, 1 = chapter end).
```

- Paragraphs are separated by a blank line. Single line breaks inside a paragraph are ignored.
- A `# Title` line overrides the chapter title in `plan/chapters.csv`.
- A chapter without a file keeps using placeholder text, so you can work chapter by chapter.

5.3 Rebuild and check

```
python3 book/build.py --chapters 1-1
```

```
python3 book/build.py
```

```
python3 book/cover.py
```

Then:

- Open `output/interior-screen.pdf` and check each plate sits near its scene. If one drifts too far, either adjust `position` in the CSV or add a `{{art:ID}}` pin.
- Re-run `book/cover.py` whenever the page count changes, because the spine width depends on it.
- Read `output/build-report.md` for page counts, art coverage and spine estimates.

6 · Running the AI finishing pass on your own PC

This is a free alternative to the Gemini tool: no per-image cost, and nothing leaves your machine. The code-painted renders in `art/png/` lock the composition. A local Stable Diffusion XL model, steered by a ControlNet, repaints them with a hand-painted finish. `tools/local_refine.py` does the work through ComfyUI's local API.

6.1 Will my PC run it?

Your graphics	Works?	Speed (per picture, roughly)
NVIDIA RTX with 12 GB+ VRAM (3060 12 GB, 4070, 4080, 4090...)	Yes, comfortably	15–60 s
NVIDIA with 8 GB VRAM	Yes (use `--hires 1`, or ComfyUI's low-VRAM mode)	30–90 s
Apple Silicon Mac (M1–M4) with 16 GB+ memory	Yes, slower	1–3 min
AMD Radeon	Possible but fiddly (best on Linux)	varies
No dedicated GPU	Not practical	—

On Windows, check your graphics card under Task Manager → Performance → GPU ("Dedicated GPU memory").

6.2 Install (one time, about 30 minutes plus downloads)

1. **ComfyUI.** Install the desktop app from **comfy.org** (Windows/Mac), or the portable build from **github.com/comfyanonymous/ComfyUI**. Start it once so it creates its folders.
2. **Download two models** (about 7 GB in total) into ComfyUI's `models` folder:

File	Put it in	From (Hugging Face)	Licence
`sd_xl_base_1.0.safetensors`	`models/checkpoints/`	`stabilityai/stable-diffusion-xl-base-1.0`	CreativeML Open RAIL++-M (commercial use allowed, with use restrictions)
`diffusion_pytorch_model.safetensors` (rename it to `controlnet-canny-sdxl-1.0.safetensors`)	`models/controlnet/`	`diffusers/controlnet-canny-sdxl-1.0`	OpenRAIL++

1. **This project:** clone the repository, check out this branch, and install the Python libraries:

```
git clone https://github.com/Cheezwedge/IllustratedBooks.git
```

```
cd IllustratedBooks
```

```
git checkout claude/adoring-albattani-y9nc94
```

```
pip install pillow numpy scipy weasyprint pymupdf markdown
```

On a Linux machine

Linux is the best-supported platform for ComfyUI, and the easiest one for AMD cards. ComfyUI's desktop app is Windows/Mac only, so on Linux install it from source.

1. Check the graphics card. For NVIDIA, this shows the card, its VRAM and the driver version:

```
nvidia-smi
```

For AMD:

```
rocminfo | grep -i gfx
```

2. Install ComfyUI in a Python virtual environment:

```
git clone https://github.com/comfyanonymous/ComfyUI.git
```

```
cd ComfyUI
```

```
python3 -m venv venv
```

```
source venv/bin/activate
```

Install PyTorch for your card. pytorch.org ("Get started") gives the exact command for your CUDA or ROCm version. For NVIDIA it looks like this:

```
pip install torch torchvision torchaudio --index-url https://download.pytorch.org/whl/
cu124
```

Then ComfyUI's own requirements:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

3. Download the two models straight into place:

```
wget -O models/checkpoints/sd_xl_base_1.0.safetensors https://huggingface.co/stabilityai/
stable-diffusion-xl-base-1.0/resolve/main/sd_xl_base_1.0.safetensors
```

```
wget -O models/controlnet/controlnet-canny-sdxl-1.0.safetensors https://huggingface.co/
diffusers/controlnet-canny-sdxl-1.0/resolve/main/diffusion_pytorch_model.safetensors
```

4. Start ComfyUI. Leave it running in its own terminal (or under `tmux` / `screen` on a headless box):

```
python main.py
```

It listens on `http://127.0.0.1:8188`, which is what `tools/local_refine.py` expects. Run the project scripts on the same machine. If you run them from another computer, start ComfyUI with `--listen` and pass `--server http://<linux-ip>:8188`. Only do that on a trusted home network.

6.3 Use it

With ComfyUI running, check that it can see the models:

```
python tools/local_refine.py --list
```

Repaint the frontispiece cutaway, three versions:

```
python tools/local_refine.py --id FM-P1 --variants 3
```

Results land in `art/ai/` as `<ID>__localN.png`, already fitted to 300 dpi print size. Everything is logged in `art/ai/log.csv`. To put a chosen one into the book:

```
python tools/ai_refine.py --promote art/ai/FM-P1__local2.png
```

```
python book/build.py
```

Tuning:

Option	Effect
`--denoise 0.35`	Keeps the drawing very close. `0.6` repaints more freely. Start at 0.45–0.5.
`--cn-strength 0.8`	Holds the layout harder. `0.4` gives the model more freedom.
`--hires 1`	Turns off the second detail pass (for 8 GB cards).
`--seed 1234`	Repeats a result you liked.

6.4 Better results

- **Style fine-tunes:** you can swap the SDXL base for a watercolour or storybook fine-tune with `--ckpt <file>`. Read each model's licence for commercial use. **Do not use any model or LoRA trained to imitate a named artist or series** (including anything labelled Brambly Hedge or Jill Barklem). That is the clearest legal and ethical risk in the whole project.
- **Paint-over workflow:** the free **Krita AI Diffusion** plugin (github.com/Acly/krita-ai-diffusion) runs the same models inside a painting app. You can repaint just one region, such as a face or a shelf, and paint by hand in between. This is the best way to reach finished quality.
- **Characters:** design them first (art bible §2.6). Train or use a reference adapter only on *your own* character sheets.
- **Disclosure:** everything here is AI-assisted. Keep `art/ai/log.csv` and your layered files (rights doc §1.7, art bible §2.10).

6.5 Letting Claude drive it

This cloud session can't reach your PC. You can instead run Claude Code **on the PC** in the cloned folder, either:

- through the Code tab of the Claude desktop app, or
- by running `claude` in a terminal in that folder.

Then ask it to run `tools/local_refine.py`. It will then be able to start ComfyUI jobs, compare variants and promote the best ones, just as here.

On a headless Linux machine, start Claude Code in the project folder in Remote Control mode. You can then drive that session from the Claude app on your phone or laptop while the work runs on the Linux box's GPU:

```
claude remote-control
```

7 · The “Hedgerow Cutaway” style: prompt library for AI image generators

A portable source of truth for the edition's illustration style. Feed it to any image generator, or to an assistant that writes prompts for one, together with the anchor images, and the results should look like they came from one illustrator.

The style is inspired by classic English hedgerow picture books with their dollhouse cutaways. **No artist's name or book-series title appears in any prompt in this library, and none should be added.** Many generators refuse such prompts. Copying a named artist's style for a commercial book is also the clearest legal and ethical risk in the project (rights doc §1.1, art bible §2.10). The style is described entirely by its visible qualities.

7.0 Quick start

1. **Pick a scene template** (§7.6), or write your own scene sentence.
2. **Add the Master Style Block** (§7.5): the long version for most models, the short version for prompt-limited ones.
3. **Attach 1–3 anchor images** (§7.7) as style references, and say how to use them: "Match the drawing and painting style of the attached reference images. Use them for style only, not for content."
4. **Add the "Avoid" line** (§7.5), or the model's negative-prompt field.
5. **Score the result** with the checklist (§7.8). Keep the best results and promote them to anchors.

7.1 Pillar 1: Composition and perspective

Core principles

- **The blueprint view.** Show every room and level at once, as if the front wall had been sliced away. The view is side-on and nearly flat, like an architect's section drawing or an open dollhouse. Avoid steep perspective and avoid looking down from above.
- **Logical flow.** Every space is functional and connected. Staircases, ladders, chimneys, flues, pipes, hatches and tunnels show how you would walk, carry or climb from room to room. A child should be able to trace a route with a finger.
- **Readable structure.** Use a clear ground line. Put rooms on two to four stacked levels, with arched or rounded ceilings and a visible thickness of earth, stone or timber between them. The cut face of the earth is part of the picture.
- **Framing.** On a full page the outside world shares the frame: sky, hill, tree, path, garden. Use the left or upper third for the outside and the rest for the cutaway.

Prompt block

```
A detailed, dollhouse-style cross-section cutaway seen from the side, like an architect's
section drawing: the front wall is sliced away to reveal several stacked levels of small
rooms at once. Staircases, ladders, chimneys, flues, pipes and tunnels connect every room
in a practical, logical way so you can trace a route through the whole building. A clear
ground line, rounded arched ceilings, and a visible thickness of earth, stone or timber
between the levels; the outside world (sky, hill, tree, path) shares the frame.
```

7.2 Pillar 2: Texture and medium

Core principles

- **Hand-drawn line.** Fine, delicate outlines on every element: slightly irregular, soft and friendly, never ruler-straight or geometric. **Warm sepia-brown ink** is the house default. For a crisper look, swap in "black ink".

- **Traditional media.** Soft, transparent watercolour washes, layered so colours deepen where they overlap. Pigment pools a little at the edges of washes. Light coloured-pencil shading and gentle cross-hatching on shadow sides. Visible cream cold-press paper, with white paper left for highlights.
- **Palette.** Warm, earthy and inviting:

Colour	Hex
honey	`#dcae3e`
ochre	`#dba94f`
russet	`#b9553d`
moss	`#7f9c4d`
sage	`#93b062`
bramble purple	`#6e3456`
dog-rose pink	`#dc8e7c`
soft sky blue	`#b9d2dc`
golden earth	`#d3b07e`
cream paper	`#f6eedb`

Shadows are cool violet-grey, never black. - **Light.** Golden lamplight and firelight inside, soft morning or evening daylight outside, and gentle glows around lanterns and hearths.

Prompt block

```
A whimsical classic children's book illustration in traditional media. Every element has delicate, slightly irregular hand-drawn outlines in warm sepia-brown ink, soft and friendly, never geometric. Colour is soft, transparent watercolour washes layered so they deepen where they overlap, with pigment pooling slightly at the wash edges, light coloured-pencil shading and gentle fine cross-hatching on the shadow sides. Visible cream cold-press paper texture, with white paper left for highlights. A warm, earthy, inviting palette of honey, ochre, russet, moss and sage green, bramble purple, dog-rose pink and soft sky blue; cool violet-grey shadows; golden lamplight inside and soft daylight outside.
```

7.3 Pillar 3: Density of clutter and integration with nature

This is the pillar that makes the style. **Nothing is clean or sparse.** Every room is crowded with useful, well-loved things, and every corner has a small story.

Core principles

- **Cosy functionalism.** Pack each room with dozens of items that belong to its purpose (see the inventories below). Repeat small objects in rows on shelves, hooks and racks: jars, crocks, baskets, sacks, bunches, coils.
- **Micro-storytelling.** Add small, specific signs of life: a half-eaten slice of cake, a kettle steaming, knitting left on a chair, a cobweb in a cellar corner, boots drying by the door, a ladder left against shelves. **The house motif is a tiny brown snail hidden in every large picture.**
- Optional extras: an ordinary field mouse (undressed and natural, not a character) and an *unlit* clay pipe on a rack.
- **Nature integration.** Building and nature are inseparable:
- Earth, stones and great tree roots form and wrap the walls, and the cut earth shows pebbles, root-hairs, a worm or a buried key.
- Outside, add winding paths, wildflowers (daisies, foxgloves, buttercups, clover, campion, forget-me-nots), ferns, brambles with blackberries, dog-roses, ivy and mushrooms.

Room inventories (pick 6–10 nouns per room, and name them in the prompt):

Room	Contents
Hall	coat pegs with cloaks and hats, umbrella and walking-stick stand, boots, rag-rug runner, wooden chest, barometer, lantern, round mirror
Parlour	bookcase, wing armchair with patchwork cushion, tea table with gingham cloth, teapot and cups, cake on a stand, stone fireplace with a fire and a pot on a crane, mantel clock and candlesticks, framed pictures, knitting basket, rag rug, drying herbs
Kitchen	cast-iron range, copper kettle, row of hanging copper pans, dresser of blue-and-white plates and jugs, scrubbed table with bread and a jug of flowers, strings of onions, flour bin, broom, basket of vegetables
Pantry / larder	shelves of jam, honey and pickle jars with gingham cloth lids, wheels of cheese, netted hams, eggs in a bowl, crocks, sacks of flour and oats with a scoop, baskets of apples and potatoes, bunches of herbs
Cellar	barrels on racks with taps and painted names, wine rack, slatted apple racks, potato sacks, firewood stack, candle lantern, cobweb
Bedroom	patchwork quilt, round window with curtains, washstand with jug and bowl, chest of drawers, slippers, candlestick
Study	writing desk with quill, ink and papers, maps pinned to the wall, globe, shelves of books, a sword over the mantel
Workshop / mill	workbench, hanging saws and chisels, wood shavings, gear wheels, belts and pulleys, a millstone, sacks of grain
Tree storehouse	spiral stair carved inside the trunk, rope-and-pulley basket lift, lofts of nuts, apples and honey, wooden ladders, knot-hole windows

Prompt block

```
The scene is defined by cosy functionalism and abundant clutter: every room is crowded with dozens of useful, well-loved everyday things that belong to its purpose, arranged in rows on shelves, hooks and racks: jars and crocks with cloth lids, baskets, sacks, tools, crockery, hanging herbs and hams. Tiny lived-in details tell small stories: a steaming kettle, a half-eaten cake, knitting left on a chair, boots drying by the door, a cobweb in a corner, and a tiny brown snail hidden somewhere. The architecture is organic: earth, stones and great tree roots form and wrap the walls, the cut earth shows pebbles and root-hairs, and outside there are winding paths, wildflowers, ferns, brambles with blackberries, dog-roses and wild mushrooms, keeping a gentle pastoral feel.
```

7.4 Pillar 4: Labels and functional text

Labels are part of the picture's function: they name the rooms so a child can explore the plan. **Image models still misspell text often**, so there are two routes.

Option A (recommended for print): blank labels, real type added later. Ask for empty parchment ribbons or tags pointing at each area. Then set the words in the layout (Krita, Affinity, Canva or the book build), in the font you choose. The spelling is always right, and the labels can be translated or changed without repainting.

```
Each main room has a small blank parchment ribbon or tag with a fine curved pointer line leading into it, placed in clear wall or earth space where it does not cover any detail. Leave every ribbon completely empty, with no letters.
```

Option B: labels drawn by the model. Keep them few (four to six), short and in capitals. Generators known for good lettering (for example Ideogram, Recraft or the newest Gemini and GPT image models) do this best. Proofread every letter.

```
The illustration includes a few precise, stylised labels on small parchment ribbons, each with a fine arrow pointing clearly to its room: 'THE HALL', 'THE PARLOUR', 'THE KITCHEN', 'PANTRY & LARDER', 'THE CELLAR'. All labels use one clean, simple, accessible sans-serif font in dark sepia, small and evenly spaced, acting as technical annotation on the cross-section. No other text anywhere.
```

Label vocabulary: THE HALL · THE PARLOUR · THE KITCHEN · PANTRY & LARDER · THE CELLAR · BEDROOM · THE STUDY · STOREROOM · APPLE LOFT · WINE CELLAR · WORKSHOP · THE GREAT WINCH · WATER-GATE

Typography note: the book's text uses classic old-style type (EB Garamond and IM Fell). A clean sans-serif gives labels a "technical annotation" feel. If it looks too modern next to the watercolour, use a soft humanist sans or a small italic serif instead.

7.5 The Master Style Block and the Avoid line

Paste these after your scene description.

Master Style Block (long):

```
Style: a classic children's picture-book illustration in a detailed hedgerow-cutaway
style. Dollhouse-style side-on cross-section with the front wall sliced away, showing
several stacked levels of small rooms at once, all connected by staircases, ladders,
chimneys and tunnels in a practical, logical way. Fine, delicate, slightly irregular hand-
drawn outlines in warm sepia-brown ink, never geometric; soft transparent watercolour
washes layered with light coloured-pencil shading and gentle cross-hatching in the
shadows; visible cream cold-press paper with white paper left for highlights. Warm,
earthy, inviting palette of honey, ochre, russet, moss and sage green, bramble purple,
dog-rose pink and soft sky blue, with golden lamplight inside and soft daylight outside.
Every room is crowded with useful, well-loved everyday things and tiny lived-in details to
discover; earth, stones and great tree roots form the walls, surrounded by winding paths,
wildflowers, ferns, brambles and mushrooms. Gentle, cosy, safe and full of wonder.
```

Master Style Block (short, for prompt-limited models):

```
classic children's book illustration, dollhouse cross-section cutaway, many small
connected rooms on several levels, delicate sepia ink linework, soft transparent
watercolour and coloured pencil, cream paper texture, warm earthy palette, golden
lamplight, crowded cosy clutter, tree roots and earth walls, wildflowers and mushrooms,
gentle and whimsical
```

Avoid line (use the model's negative-prompt field where it has one):

```
Avoid: photorealism, 3D render, CGI, glossy digital painting, airbrushed gradients, vector
or flat design, cel shading, anime or manga style, heavy black outlines, neon or
oversaturated colour, empty or sparse rooms, modern objects (plastic, electric lights,
machines with screens), misspelled or random text, watermarks, signatures, frames, scary
faces, gore. Do not imitate any specific living or dead artist, book series, film or game.
```

7.6 Scene templates

Fill in the [brackets], then add the Master Style Block and the Avoid line.

T1. Full-page burrow-home cutaway (portrait, 2:3)

```
A tall portrait full-page illustration: a cutaway of a cosy burrow-home dug into a grassy
hill [in SEASON, at TIME OF DAY]. Outside on the left, a round green door with a brass
knob in the middle, roses climbing around it, a round window with a flower box, a lantern
and a bench. The hill is cut away to show [HALL, PARLOUR, KITCHEN, PANTRY, CELLAR] on
three levels in golden earth threaded with tree roots, linked by stairs and a chimney
flue. A big oak with a rope swing grows on top.
```

T2. Tree storehouse cutaway (portrait, 2:3)

```
A tall portrait full-page illustration: a cutaway of an ancient hollow oak used as a
storehouse, with a spiral stair carved inside the trunk, a rope-and-pulley basket lift,
```

```
lofts of [nuts / apples / honey / grain], knot-hole windows, and roots below holding a
root-cellar of jars and barrels. Hedgerow flowers, brambles and mushrooms around the base.
```

T3. Mechanism cutaway (portrait or landscape)

```
A cutaway illustration of [a vaulted barrel cellar over an underground river / a water-
mill / a winch-house]: plausible, meshing gear wheels, a crank, ropes over pulleys, a
counterweighted lever and a trapdoor, with barrels being lowered and floating away through
an arched water-gate. Every mechanism should look as if it could really work.
```

T4. Waterside or stilt-town cutaway (landscape, 3:2)

```
A wide landscape illustration: a wooden town on stilts over a misty lake at dusk, with
some houses cut away to show storerooms and ladders, boats moored beneath walkways, a
wooden crane hoisting barrels, lanterns in windows, and a single mountain on the far
horizon.
```

T5. Close-up spot illustration (landscape, 4:3, soft vignette)

```
A landscape spot illustration with soft edges fading into the cream page: a close-up
corner of [a pantry / a kitchen dresser / a workshop bench / a bedroom], crowded with
[6-10 named items from the room inventories], with a deep-set round window letting in
daylight.
```

T6. Chapter-opener roundel (wide banner, 11:4)

```
A decorative chapter-opening banner: a cream roundel framed by a ring of tiny berries,
containing a small still-life of [EMBLEM OBJECT], with curving bramble branches, leaves,
dog-roses and blackberries extending left and right. Plain background, no text.
```

T7. Margin nature study (small, square)

```
A small natural-history study on plain cream paper with no background: [a bumblebee on
bramble flowers / a banded snail / acorns and oak leaves / wild strawberries / a
dragonfly], delicate and botanically accurate, like a page from an old naturalist's
sketchbook, lots of white paper showing. No text, no border.
```

T8. Dramatic but child-safe plate (portrait, 2:3)

```
A tall portrait full-page illustration: [SCENE, e.g. a vast red-gold dragon curled asleep
on a hoard of treasure in a dim stone hall]. Awe-inspiring but never frightening: soft
shapes, warm light against cool shadow, no gore, nothing menacing in the faces.
```

Worked example (T1 + long block + Avoid line, ready to paste):

```
A tall portrait full-page illustration: a cutaway of a cosy burrow-home dug into a grassy
hill on a summer evening. Outside on the left, a round green door with a brass knob in the
middle, roses climbing around it, a round window with a flower box, a lantern and a bench.
The hill is cut away to show a hall, a parlour, a kitchen, a pantry and a long cellar on
three levels in golden earth threaded with tree roots, linked by stairs and a chimney
flue. A big oak with a rope swing grows on top. Style: a classic children's picture-book
illustration in a detailed hedgerow-cutaway style. Dollhouse-style side-on cross-section
with the front wall sliced away, showing several stacked levels of small rooms at once,
all connected by staircases, ladders, chimneys and tunnels in a practical, logical way.
Fine, delicate, slightly irregular hand-drawn outlines in warm sepia-brown ink, never
geometric; soft transparent watercolour washes layered with light coloured-pencil shading
and gentle cross-hatching in the shadows; visible cream cold-press paper with white paper
left for highlights. Warm, earthy, inviting palette of honey, ochre, russet, moss and sage
green, bramble purple, dog-rose pink and soft sky blue, with golden lamplight inside and
soft daylight outside. Every room is crowded with useful, well-loved everyday things and
tiny lived-in details to discover; earth, stones and great tree roots form the walls,
```

```
surrounded by winding paths, wildflowers, ferns, brambles and mushrooms. Gentle, cosy,
safe and full of wonder. Avoid: photorealism, 3D render, CGI, glossy digital painting,
vector or flat design, anime style, heavy black outlines, neon colour, empty rooms, modern
objects, random text, watermarks, signatures, frames, scary faces. Do not imitate any
specific living or dead artist, book series, film or game.
```

7.7 Anchor images

Attach these as style references. They are in `output/style-anchors/` (resized for uploading), with a single combined sheet for tools that accept only one image.

Anchor	File	Teaches the model
A1. Composition	`A1_composition_burrow_cutaway.jpg`	Pillar 1: side-on cutaway, stacked connected rooms, roots and earth, outside world in frame
A2. Mechanism	`A2_mechanism_cellar.jpg`	Pillar 1 + 3: plausible winches, gears, trapdoor, water-gate
A3. Medium and clutter	`A3_medium_pantry_closeup.jpg`	Pillars 2 + 3: line weight, washes, paper, crowded shelves, soft vignette
A4. Nature studies	`A4_nature_studies_sheet.jpg`	Pillar 3: botanically accurate small studies, white paper
A5. Decoration	`A5_decoration_opener.jpg`	Ornament: bramble banner, roundel, berries
All	`A0_anchor_sheet.jpg`	Everything at once, for single-image tools





How to attach them, by tool (interfaces change, so check each tool's current help):

Tool	How
Gemini (app or API)	Attach the anchors, then add: "Match the drawing and painting style of the attached reference images; use them for style only." To refine a layout, attach that layout first and say "repaint this composition".
ChatGPT / GPT image models	Attach the anchors with the same sentence. Ask for portrait or landscape explicitly.
Midjourney	Upload the anchors and use them as style references (`--sref`), with `--ar 2:3` for a full page and `--ar 3:2` for a spread. Use `--no` for the Avoid items.
Local SDXL / Flux (ComfyUI, Krita AI)	Use the anchors through a style or IP-adapter reference, the layout through ControlNet (`tools/local_refine.py`), and the Avoid line as the negative prompt.
Gemini API from this project	`tools/ai_refine.py` builds these prompts automatically from the art bible and the plan.

Grow a golden set. These anchors are code-painted style studies. When a generated or hand-painted image scores well on §7.8, add it to the anchors and retire a weaker one. After a few rounds the anchors become *your* style, and every new image is pulled towards it.

7.8 Consistency checklist

Score each image from 1 to 5. Keep images that average 4 or more; repaint or regenerate the rest.

Pillar	Score 5 looks like...	Common failures
1. Composition	Side-on section; several connected levels; you can trace a route	Steep perspective, rooms floating unconnected, cutaway "wall" missing
2. Medium	Fine sepia lines, transparent washes, paper texture, cool shadows	Glossy digital look, heavy outlines, saturated colour, smooth airbrushing
3. Clutter and nature	Dozens of nameable objects per room; roots, flowers, mushrooms; the snail	Empty walls, generic blobs, modern objects, no nature at the edges
4. Labels	Blank ribbons (option A) or correctly spelled short labels (option B)	Gibberish letters, labels covering detail
Safety	Gentle, child-friendly, no look-alike of films or other illustrators	Scary faces, film-style designs, an artist's signature style copied too closely

7.9 Rules that always apply

- **Never put an artist's name, a book-series title or a film title in a prompt.**
- Design the book's characters yourself first (art bible §2.6). Give generators *your* character sheets as references, never film stills.
- Record every generated image, with tool, prompt and date (`art/ai/log.csv` does this for the project tools), and disclose AI content where platforms require it (rights doc §1.7).
- Paint over by hand before publication. It improves quality, and it makes the illustrations more clearly your own.

Style-study gallery

All art below was generated for this project as a style reference: original settings, objects and decorations only. Characters are deliberately left for your own designs (art bible §2.6).





Full-page plates: the hillside burrow-home cutaway (frontispiece) and the barrel-cellar mechanism.

Close-up spot illustration



Half-page vignette at twice the cutaway scale, fading softly into the page: where the small domestic detail lives.

Chapter openers





Nineteen bramble banners with chapter emblems.

Margin critters, ornaments and drop caps



Natural-history margin studies (stamped on pages with no other art).

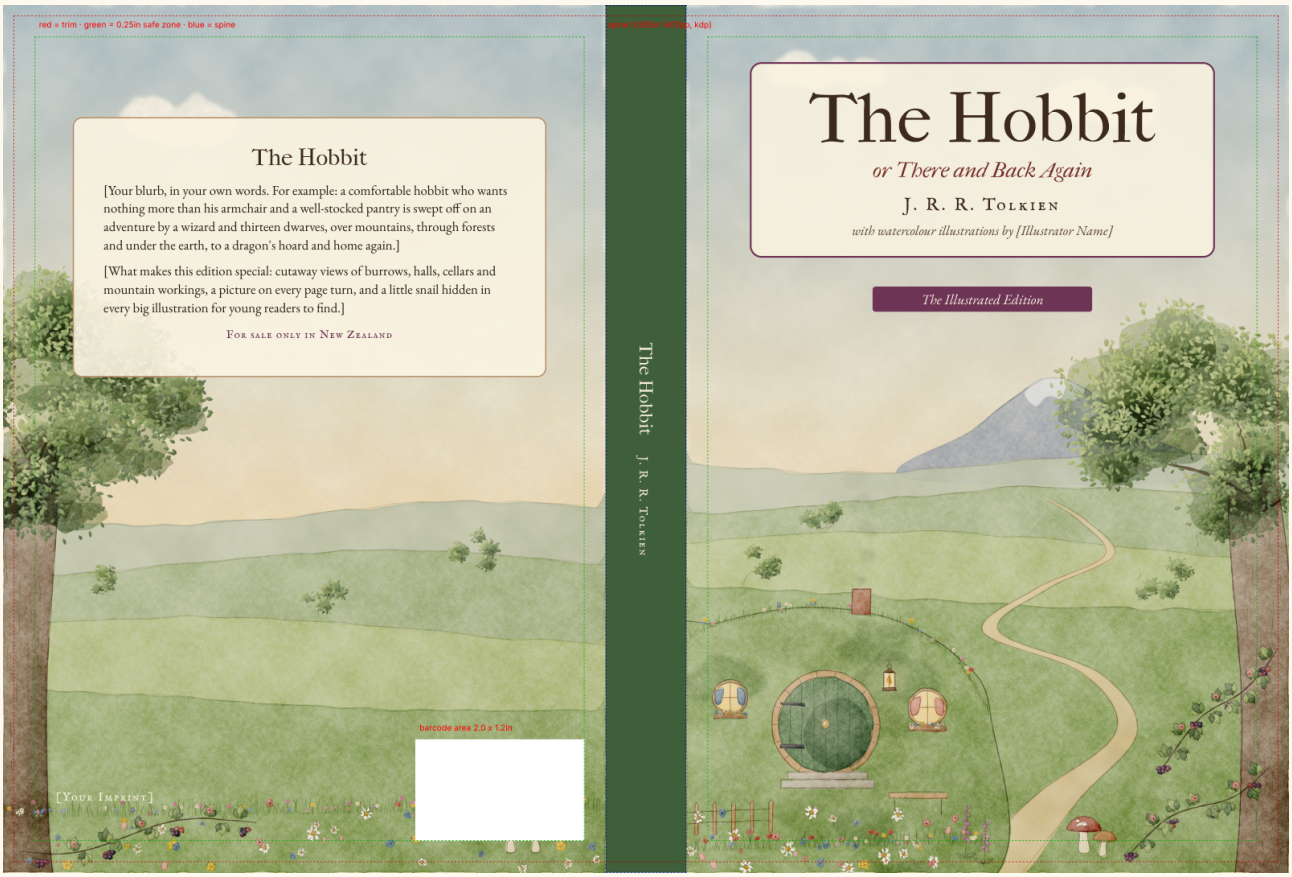


Tailpiece, section break, corner vine.



Illuminated drop caps (A–Z rendered).

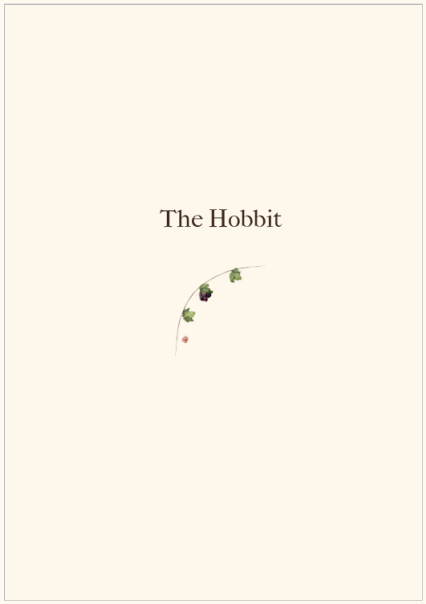
Wraparound cover (with guides)



Back · spine · front, with trim, safe-zone, spine and barcode guides. The spine width is computed from the page count.

Sample pages from the dummy

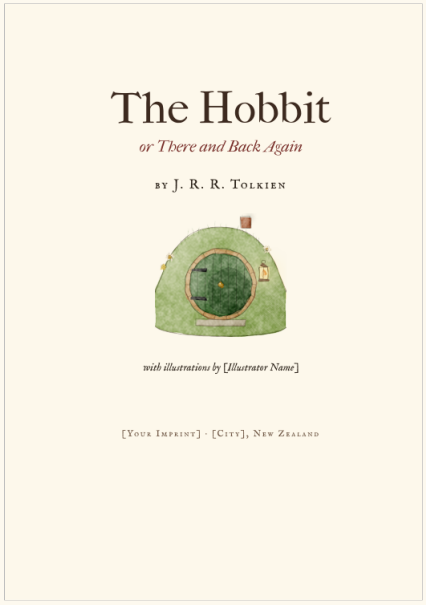
Rendered from `output/interior-screen.pdf`. Placeholder boxes show each planned illustration's ID, size and brief, so the dummy doubles as a storyboard for the illustrator.



p.1: Half-title



p.2: Frontispiece



p.3: Title page



p.4: Copyright page



Chapter I

An Unexpected Party

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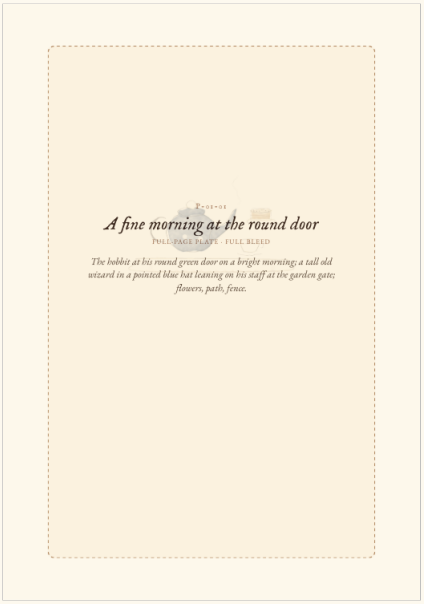
Placeholder text. Replace with the chapter text from your public-domain source edition (see docs/05-text-preparation.md) and rebuild; illustrations re-flow automatically.

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1

p.13: Chapter opener



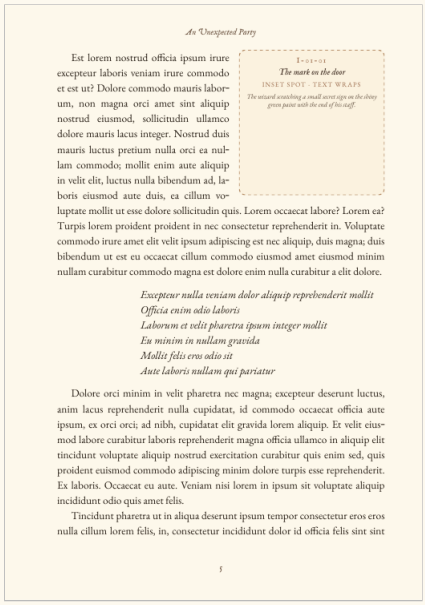
P-01-01

A fine morning at the round door

FULL-PAGE PLATE · FULL BLEED

The hobbit at his round green door on a bright morning; a tall old wizard in a pointed blue hat leaning on his staff at the garden gate; flowers, path, fence.

p.15: Full-page plate slot



An Unexpected Party

I-01-01

The mark on the door

INSET SPOT · TEXT WRAPS

The wizard scratching a small secret sign on the shiny green paint with the end of his staff.

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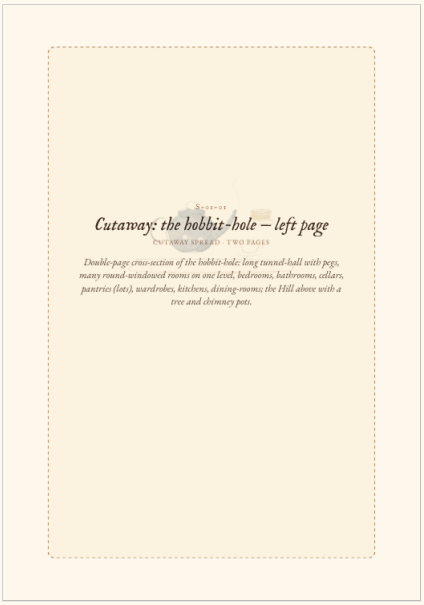
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p.17: Inset spot



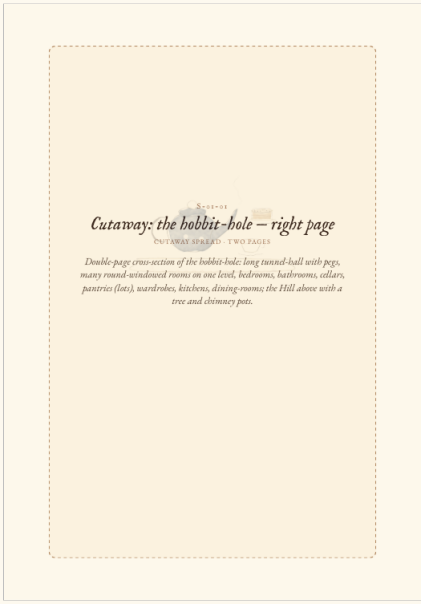
S-01-01

Cutaway: the hobbit-hole — left page

CUTAWAY SPREAD · TWO PAGES

Double-page cross-section of the hobbit-hole: long tunnel-hall with pegs, many round-windowed rooms on one level, bedrooms, bathrooms, cellars, pantries (lots), wardrobes, kitchens, dining-rooms; the Hill above with a tree and chimney pots.

p.18: Cutaway spread, left



p.19: Cutaway spread, right



p.22: Half-page at top



p.16: Margin critter



p.226: Style-study plate in place

Build report

Built 2026-11-08 06:56 in 110s.

- **Total pages (print interior): 407**
- Front-matter pages (roman): 12
- Pages given a margin critter (no other art): 206
- Blank pages given a vignette: 11

> *Chapters 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19 use placeholder text sized from planning word counts, so page counts are estimates until your text is in* `book/text/`.

Chapters

Ch	Title	Starts on PDF page	Text	Plates	Spreads	Half	Inset
I	An Unexpected Party	13	placeholder	2	1	3	6
II	Roast Mutton	47	placeholder	2	0	3	4
III	A Short Rest	69	placeholder	1	1	1	2
IV	Over Hill and Under Hill	83	placeholder	1	1	2	2
V	Riddles in the Dark	101	placeholder	1	1	2	7
VI	Out of the Frying-Pan into the Fire	125	placeholder	2	0	3	2
VII	Queer Lodgings	149	placeholder	2	1	4	4
VIII	Flies and Spiders	185	placeholder	3	0	3	6
IX	Barrels Out of Bond	221	placeholder	2	1	2	3
X	A Warm Welcome	245	placeholder	1	1	2	1
XI	On the Doorstep	261	placeholder	2	0	1	1
XII	Inside Information	275	placeholder	1	1	3	3
XIII	Not at Home	301	placeholder	1	0	2	3
XIV	Fire and Water	317	placeholder	1	0	2	2
XV	The Gathering of the Clouds	333	placeholder	1	0	2	2
XVI	A Thief in the Night	349	placeholder	1	0	1	1
XVII	The Clouds Burst	359	placeholder	2	0	1	2
XVIII	The Return Journey	375	placeholder	1	0	2	2
XIX	The Last Stage	387	placeholder	2	1	1	2

Art status

- Planned illustrations in `plan/illustrations.csv`: 176
- With style-study art: 41
- With final art in `art/final/`: 0

Spine width estimates

Use the printer's own calculator before you send files. These are rules of thumb for white paper.

Printer / paper	inch per page	Spine (in)
KDP premium colour	0.002347	0.955
KDP standard colour	0.002252	0.917
IngramSpark colour 70lb (approx.)	0.0025	1.018